This formula returns the day of the year for a date in cell A1:

=A1-DATE(YEAR(A1),1,0)

Note: Excel automatically formats the cell as a date, so change the number format to another option (like General).

To calculate the number of days remaining in the year (assuming that the date is in cell A1), use the following formula:

=DATE(YEAR(A1),12,31)-A1

3.6.1.8 Calculating A Conditional Average

In the real world, a simple average often isn't adequate for your needs. For example, an instructor might calculate student grades by averaging a series of test scores but omitting the two lowest scores. Or you might want to compute an average that ignores both the highest and lowest values.

In cases such as these, the AVERAGE function won't do, so you must create a more complex formula. The following Excel formula computes the average of the values contained in a range named 'scores,' but excludes the highest and lowest values:

=(SUM(scores)-MIN(scores)-MAX(scores))/(COUNT(scores)-2)

Here's an example that calculates an average excluding the two lowest scores:

=(SUM(scores)-MIN(scores)-SMALL(scores,2))/(COUNT(scores)-2)

3.6.1.9 Calculate The Number Of Days In A Month

Excel lacks a function for calculating the number of days in a particular month, but there's a way out. If cell A1 contains a date, this formula will return the number of days in the month:

=DAY(DATE(YEAR(A1),MONTH(A1)+1,1)-1).